

Eco-Friendly Travel Options in the City

Public Transport

- Metro rail is generally the lowest-emission option per passenger-kilometer for urban commutes where available.
- City buses, including electric and CNG bus fleets being rolled out in several Indian cities, are a low-emission alternative to private cars for medium-to-long commutes.
- Suburban rail is a strong option for longer intra-city or inter-city commutes in metros that have it.

Shared & Micro-Mobility

- Carpooling or ride-sharing apps reduce per-person emissions compared to solo driving.
- Bicycle-sharing and e-cycle rental schemes are increasingly available in tech parks, university campuses, and select city zones — good for short last-mile trips.
- E-scooter rentals can replace short car/auto trips, particularly for distances under 3-4 km.

Active Travel

- Walking and cycling produce zero direct emissions and are best suited for trips under 2-3 km.
- Many cities are expanding dedicated cycling lanes and pedestrian zones — check your city's transport authority app or website for updated route maps.

Electric & Low-Emission Personal Vehicles

- Electric two-wheelers and cars qualify for central and state subsidies under India's EV promotion schemes (see the Government Schemes document), which can meaningfully lower upfront cost.
- Look for EV charging stations at malls, tech parks, and public parking lots — availability is expanding rapidly in most metros.
- CNG-run autos and cabs are a lower-emission alternative to petrol/diesel when EVs aren't accessible.

Longer-Distance / Intercity Travel

- Trains are significantly lower-emission per passenger-km than flying for intercity routes.
- Bus travel (especially electric or CNG intercity buses where available) is generally lower-emission than flying or solo driving for medium distances.
- If flying is unavoidable, choosing non-stop routes and economy class (which has a lower per-passenger footprint than business/first class) reduces the trip's relative impact.

Practical Tips

- Combine errands into a single trip to reduce total distance traveled.

- Use trip-planning or transit apps to choose routes with fewer transfers and less idle time in traffic.
- Maintain your vehicle (tire pressure, servicing) if you do drive — a poorly maintained vehicle burns more fuel per km.